Personal Financial Diagnostics Booklet

Part A: Your Financial Behaviour Profile

The Productivity Hacker

An action-oriented spender who pays premium prices for shortcuts and convenience, creating expensive dependency habits.

✅ Financial Strength

You take quick action, willing to find and pay for shortcuts to resolve immediate personal discomforts or academic pressure.

⚠️ Behavioural Blind Spot

Buying present comfort (e.g., expensive coffee, daily ride-shares) concentrates spending on 'convenience premiums', emptying your wallet.

⚡ Typical Risk Scenario

Trapped in a dependency loop. Once accustomed to buying time and energy, any disruption in income (e.g., losing a gig) causes your lifestyle to collapse immediately.

💡 Personalized Recommendation

Watch out for 'Dependency Spending'. Replace paid chemical boosts or ride-shares with free healthy habits like proper sleep and exercise.

Part B: Other Campus Student Archetypes

Understand common financial behavioral patterns on campus to avoid falling into the same traps:

The Balanced Strategist

A financial master who balances social life and savings by leveraging the collaborative economy and DIY alternatives.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** When faced with large unexpected expenses, you might hesitate due to over-analyzing costs or peer feelings, missing the best window to resolve the crisis.

The Cautious Socialite

A conservative planner who values relationships and avoids debt, but passively compromises in group spending.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** Passively yielding to expensive group habits gradually drains your emergency reserve in an 'unnoticed' state.

The Experience Seeker

A social enthusiast who actively hunts for discounts to maximize group fun, but lacks saving habits.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** After attending multiple orientation camps or parties, a sudden laptop breakdown or mandatory academic fee will leave you completely paralyzed.

The YOLO Spender

A highly social spender who prioritizes current vibes and connections, easily falling prey to FOMO-driven choices.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** Unable to say 'no', you max out credit cards mid-semester, forcing you to rely on high-interest loans to survive the rest of the term.

The Ambitious Optimizer

A focused achiever who leverages technology for academic efficiency, but neglects building a social support network.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** Social isolation during crises. When a real emergency hits (e.g., getting sick or needing group project support), you find yourself without a helpful network.

The Extreme Survivor

A disciplined saver who sacrifices health and social life for extreme security, risking physical and mental burnout.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** Long-term malnutrition or sleep deprivation causes a physical breakdown during mid-terms, ironically forcing high medical bills and ruining grades.

The Anxious Avoider

An overwhelmed student who passively avoids financial planning under pressure, letting small mistakes snowball into major crises.

⚠️ **Risk & Blind Spot:** A minor setback (e.g., losing attendance points) triggers a butterfly effect of total avoidance, resulting in failed courses and unmanageable debt.

Part C: Practical Money Tips for University Students

No matter your archetype, these 9 low-effort micro-habits will help you effortlessly protect your wallet:

1. The Wage-Converter Hack

How it works: Next time you want to buy a $60 jacket, divide the price by your hourly part-time wage (e.g., $10/hr). Ask yourself: "Is this jacket worth standing for 6 hours serving food?" If it hurts, your brain will hit the brakes.

2. Add Digital Friction

How it works: Unlink your credit card from food delivery apps and shopping platforms. Having to physically find your card and type 16 digits when ordering late-night snacks adds enough hassle to eliminate 50% of impulse buys.

3. Lazy Tracking ("Track Big, Ignore Small")

How it works: Stop tracking every $2 drink. Only log fixed expenses and non-essential purchases over $15. Set a weekly cash budget for daily meals (e.g., $100)—when it's gone, wait until next week. Zero tracking fatigue.

4. Maximize Student Privilege

How it works: Turn asking for discounts into muscle memory. Whether buying hardware, transit passes, software, or movie tickets, always ask: "Is there a student discount?" Getting rejected costs nothing; getting a discount is risk-free arbitrage.

5. Separate three kinds of money

How it works: Track cash, reserve and repayments separately. Transfers are not income and borrowing is not earnings.

6. Compare the whole cost

How it works: Compare price, time, usefulness and alternatives. The cheapest choice may not be the best fit.

7. Review subscriptions

How it works: Note the charge date, price, usage and cancellation terms. Consider free alternatives before renewing.

8. Keep a workable backup

How it works: Back up important files and check campus loan resources and support channels before you need them.

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9. My seven-day action

How it works: Choose one action and decide when and how to do it. For example, review one subscription on Wednesday and note its renewal date and fee.

What goal would you like to achieve in the next 7 days?

My goal is:

When will I start, and what is my first step?

How will I know I have achieved my goal?